Word Progressions & Sequences

Year 4 · Supplementary Worksheet — extra practice & worked breakdowns

Worked Examples

Example 1 — Spotting the step size: In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: SKY → TLZ → ? What comes next?

Answer: Each letter moved forward 1 place (S→T, K→L, Y→Z). Moving forward 1 more place: T→U, L→M, Z→A (wrapping round the alphabet). Answer: UMA.

Example 2 — Finding a missing middle term: Find the step size, then give the missing word: ZOO → APP → ___ → CRR

Answer: Each letter moves forward 1 place per step (Z→A, O→P, O→P). The missing word moves forward 1 more place from APP: BQQ.

Example 3 — A bigger step size: In this word progression, each letter moves forward 2 places each step: TEA → VGC → ? What comes next?

Answer: Moving forward 2 more places from VGC: V→X, G→I, C→E. Answer: XIE.

Example 4 — Working with wraparound: In this word progression, each letter moves forward 3 places each step: WAX → ZDA → ? What comes next?

Answer: Moving forward 3 more places: Z→C (wrapping past Z back to A, B, C), D→G, A→D. Answer: CGD.

Example 5 — Multiple choice: Each letter in this progression moves forward 2 place(s) in the alphabet each step: GEM → IGO → ? A) KIQ B) JHP C) KIR D) LJQ

Answer: A — KIQ (each letter moves forward 2 more places: I→K, G→I, O→Q).

Foundation

(15 questions)

1. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: SKY → TLZ → ? What comes next?
2. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: ZOO → BQQ → ? What comes next?
3. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: TEA → WHD → ? What comes next?

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4. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: OIL → PJM → ? What comes next?
5. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: GEM → IGO → ? What comes next?
6. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: FAN → IDQ → ? What comes next?
7. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: NET → OFU → ? What comes next?
8. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: JUG → LWI → ? What comes next?
9. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: MUD → PXG → ? What comes next?
10. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: WAX → XBY → ? What comes next?
11. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: RUG → TWI → ? What comes next?
12. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: VAN → YDQ → ? What comes next?
13. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: YAM → ZBN → ? What comes next?
14. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: GYM → IAO → ? What comes next?
15. In this word progression, each letter moves forward by the same number of places in the alphabet: SIP → VLS → ? What comes next?

Standard

(20 questions)

1. Find the step size, then give the missing word: SKY → TLZ → ___ → VNB
2. Find the step size, then give the missing word: ZOO → BQQ → ___ → FUU
3. Find the step size, then give the missing word: TEA → WHD → ___ → CNJ
4. Find the step size, then give the missing word: OIL → SMP → ___ → AUX
5. Find the step size, then give the missing word: GEM → HFN → ___ → JHP
6. Find the step size, then give the missing word: FAN → HCP → ___ → LGT
7. Find the step size, then give the missing word: NET → QHW → ___ → WNC
8. Find the step size, then give the missing word: JUG → NYK → ___ → VGS
9. Find the step size, then give the missing word: MUD → NVE → ___ → PXG
10. Find the step size, then give the missing word: WAX → YCZ → ___ → CGD

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11. Find the step size, then give the missing word: RUG → UXJ → ___ → ADP
12. Find the step size, then give the missing word: VAN → ZER → ___ → HMZ
13. Find the step size, then give the missing word: YAM → ZBN → ___ → BDP
14. Find the step size, then give the missing word: GYM → IAO → ___ → MES
15. Find the step size, then give the missing word: SIP → VLS → ___ → BRY
16. Find the step size, then give the missing word: TIN → XMR → ___ → FUZ
17. Find the step size, then give the missing word: LOG → MPH → ___ → ORJ
18. Find the step size, then give the missing word: DEN → FGP → ___ → JKT
19. Find the step size, then give the missing word: FIG → ILJ → ___ → ORP
20. Find the step size, then give the missing word: HUB → LYF → ___ → TGN

Hard

(5 questions)

1. Each letter in this progression moves forward by 1 place(s) in the alphabet each step: TIN → UJO → ? A) VKP B) WLQ C) YNS D) UJO
2. Each letter in this progression moves forward by 2 place(s) in the alphabet each step: LOG → NQI → ? A) ORJ B) QTL C) PSK D) NQI
3. Each letter in this progression moves forward by 3 place(s) in the alphabet each step: DEN → GHQ → ? A) IJS B) KLU C) JKT D) GHQ
4. Each letter in this progression moves forward by 4 place(s) in the alphabet each step: FIG → JMK → ? A) NQO B) JMK C) MPN D) ORP
5. Each letter in this progression moves forward by 5 place(s) in the alphabet each step: HUB → MZG → ? A) QDK B) MZG C) SFM D) REL

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